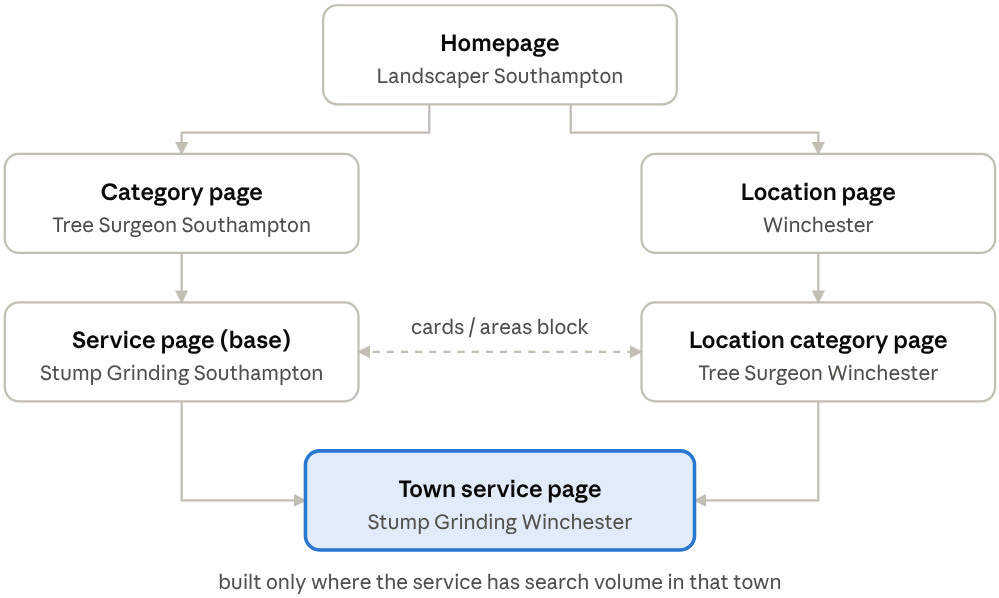
Local Service Site Page Structure

Oct 19, 2026 · @Brandon

The page hierarchy

Six page types. The category branch holds the content; the location branch holds the town pages that link into it. Solid arrows are parent-to-child; the dashed line is the two-way link between a base service page's areas block and a location category page's cards.

Two branches from the homepage meet at the town service page



page hierarchy · 6 page types

When no town service page exists for a town, the location category page's cards link to the base service page, and the base service page's areas block links to the location category page.

Which pages get built

Search volume decides. A keyword counts as usable when it has more than 10 searches a month in DataForSEO; anything at 10 or below, or with no data, is not usable.

Page type	Built when	H1
Homepage	Always	Primary category + base town (manual or research)
Category page	One per category, always	Best usable keyword, else "<Category> <Base town>"
Service page (base)	The service has a usable keyword in the base town, or in any town, or the client flags it as core	Best usable keyword, else "<Service> <Base town>"
Location page	One per town, always	Best usable keyword, else "<Primary category> Services in and around <Town>"
Location category page	One per category per town, always	Best usable keyword, else "<Category> <Town>"
Town service page	Only where "<service> <town>" has a usable keyword	That keyword

Services with no usable keyword anywhere and no core flag get no page. They are mentioned on their category page (see Services list rules).

No two pages on one site may target the same keyword. Close variants (plurals, "services", "in", "near me", word order, and keywords Google Ads reports with identical volume and CPC) count as the same keyword. A page's own name beats a synonym; if that ties, page-type priority is Homepage, Category, Service, Location, Location category.

Services list rules at intake

The services list is cleaned before any page is planned. Three rules run in order.

1. **Dedupe.** Normalise every service name the same way keywords are normalised (plural, "services", "&" vs "and", word order). Two names that collapse to the same key become one page. The page keeps the shorter name and records "merged from <other name>". Both parent categories link to it. Example: "Garden design" and "Garden designs" become one page.
2. **Fold.** If a service's keyword falls into the same group as one of a category's candidate keywords, including the category's synonym candidates, the service is not a page. It is listed on that category page and the category keeps the keyword. Example: "Garden

landscaping" folds into Landscape Gardener; "Garden design" folds into Landscape Designer; "Oven cleaning" does not fold into Carpet Cleaner.

3. **Page or mention.** A remaining service gets a base page if it has a usable keyword in any town, or the client flags it as core. Otherwise it is mentioned, not paged: one line on its category page, no card. Any mentioned service can be promoted to a page later.

US-centric names from a Google Business Profile services list (desert landscaping, sod installation, bumper block installation) should be removed from the profile as well, not given a page to justify them.

What each page contains and how far its copy reaches

A base page is not a one-town page. Its H1 names the base town because that is where the search volume is; its copy covers the whole service area. Only the town-level pages are written for one town.

Page type	Geographic scope of the copy	Services shown
Category page	Base town as home, plus the wider area by name ("across Southampton and the surrounding Hampshire towns")	A card per service that has a page, linking to the base service page; a one-line mention of services with no page
Service page (base)	Base town as home, plus the wider area; the areas block lists every town	None (it is the service)
Location page	That town only: local soil, property types, named jobs	A card per category, linking to the location category pages
Location category page	That town only	A card per service that has a page, linking to the town service page if one exists for that town, else to the base service page; the same one-line mention of unpaged services
Town service page	That town only, and that service only	None

The mention of unpaged services is one sentence ("We also offer crown reduction, pollarding, cabling, transplanting, stump removal and felling") or a short bulleted list with a few words each. Never a paragraph per service: if a service earns a paragraph, it earns a page.

The cards grid has no fixed count. A category with two paged services shows two cards; one with nine shows nine, or the top four by volume with a "see all" link.

Linking rules

Base pages link wide; town pages link tight. A base page covers the whole area, so it links to every town. A town page belongs to one town, so it never links to another town.

From	Links to
Homepage	Every category page, every location page
Category page	Its base service pages (cards); every location category page for that category (areas block)
Service page (base)	Its category page (breadcrumb); every town (areas block): the town service page where one exists for this service, else the location category page for that town
Location page	Its location category pages (cards); the homepage (breadcrumb)
Location category page	Its location page and its base category page (breadcrumb); its services (cards): the town service page if one exists for that town, else the base service page; sibling location category pages in the same town
Town service page	Its location category page and location page (breadcrumb); its base service page (body link, "see our full <service> service"); sibling town service pages in the same town. Nothing in any other town.

Anchor text on a town page is the plain service name ("Tree stump grinding"), not the destination page's H1 ("Tree Stump Grinding Southampton").

A card is never unlinked. If a service deserves a card, it has a page to link to.

Worked example: Tree Surgeon with ten services

Tree Surgeon has ten services: stump grinding, tree removal, hedge trimming, tree planting, crown reduction, pollarding, cabling, transplanting, stump removal, felling. Southampton has usable volume for stump grinding, tree removal and hedge trimming. Winchester has usable volume for stump grinding and tree planting. No other town has any.

Six pages are built.

Page	Why
Tree Stump Grinding Southampton (base)	Southampton volume
Tree Removal Southampton (base)	Southampton volume
Hedge Trimming Southampton (base)	Southampton volume
Tree Planting Southampton (base, pattern H1)	No Southampton volume, but Winchester has some, so the base page exists as its parent
Tree Stump Grinding Winchester (town)	Winchester volume
Tree Planting Winchester (town)	Winchester volume

The other six services get no page.

Category page	Cards	Card links	Under the cards
Tree Surgeon Southampton	Stump grinding, tree removal, hedge trimming, tree planting	All four to the base pages	"We also offer crown reduction, pollarding, cabling, transplanting, stump removal and felling."

Category page	Cards	Card links	Under the cards
Tree Surgeon Winchester	Same four	Stump grinding and tree planting to the Winchester pages; tree removal and hedge trimming to the base pages	Same sentence
Tree Surgeon Romsey (and the other 11 towns)	Same four	All four to the base pages	Same sentence

Tree Planting Southampton and Tree Planting Winchester point at each other: the Southampton page's areas block sends its Winchester entry to the Winchester page; the Winchester page's breadcrumb and body link go back to the Southampton page.

Template changes on the category page

- [ ] Add an "also offered" line under the services cards: one sentence or a short list, same section, smaller type, no links, no cards. Used on category pages and location category pages.
- [ ] Make the cards grid wrap to any count (2 to 12), with no fixed four.
- [ ] Add breadcrumbs under the header on every page type: Home > Category; Home > Category > Service; Home > Town; Home > Town > Category; Home > Town > Category > Service.
- [ ] In the areas block, each town entry links to the town service page where one exists, else to the location category page.
- [ ] Drop the town from two or three of the H2s (Common Problems, 3 Simple Steps) so not every heading reads "<Category> in <Town>".
- [ ] Lazy-load both map embeds, or replace the footer map with a static image linking to the Business Profile.
- [ ] Add a gallery or before-and-after section; real job photos with location-aware alt text.
- [ ] Card and anchor text on location category pages is the plain service name, without the town.

Templates

Four templates cover every page: category (also used for location category pages), service (also used for town service pages), location, and homepage. The same template serves the base and town versions; only the content and link targets differ.

Location page template

- [ ] The four cards are the town's category pages (Gardener Romsey, Tree Surgeon Romsey), not services. Relabel and link accordingly.
- [ ] "We also cover" under the areas list is the place for villages and neighbourhoods with no page of their own.
- [ ] Add the breadcrumb row.

Service page template

- [ ] Add the areas block ("Where We Provide [SVC_NAME] Across [CITY] & [AREA_WIDE]") between the FAQ and "More [CAT_NAME] Services".
- [ ] On a base service page the areas block lists every town, each linked to the town service page where one exists, otherwise to that town's location category page.
- [ ] On a town service page the same block lists the villages and neighbourhoods around that town, unlinked. "More services" cards link to sibling town service pages where they exist, else to base pages.
- [ ] "More services" grid wraps to any count rather than fixed at three.
- [ ] Add the breadcrumb row.